

Turn a client request into a design brief

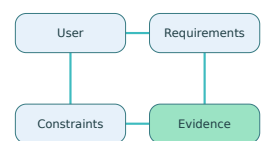
“I need a practical wardrobe” is a starting point, not a specification. Turn it into a brief that identifies the user, contents, constraints and evidence needed to accept the design.

What you will accomplish

- Ask about use before choosing a form.
- Separate confirmed requirements from assumptions.
- Write an acceptance criterion you can actually check.

Start with the user and activity

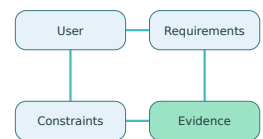
Identify who will use the furniture, what they will do and how often. Ask for an inventory and the dimensions of the largest item before proposing shelves. Shared use can involve different reach needs. Rank requests as essential, important or optional, and record who confirmed each requirement.



User → activity → contents → requirements

Record constraints and assumptions

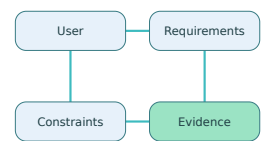
Record the available space, openings, services, budget, deadline and maintenance needs. Distinguish the client's statements from measured facts. An unknown appliance size or fixing substrate remains an open item with an owner and a design impact. Using an assumed value in a drawing does not confirm it.



Each assumption needs a question, an owner and an impact

Make acceptance testable

Connect each requirement to evidence. To store a particular bag, confirm its dimensions and test its insertion path in a drawing or mock-up. For maintenance access, identify the service point and how it can be reached. Review the brief with the client before developing options, and retain unresolved items rather than concealing them.



Requirement + verification
evidence = acceptance
criterion

From vague request to a usable brief

A client needs entrance storage for two daily bags and keys. The available space and door swing are unconfirmed. Record the inventory, measure the bags and survey the entrance. Treat the preferred colour as a choice to review with a sample.

Decision: keep the depth and frontage open until the door swing and bag insertion paths have been checked.

Check understanding

How should an unconfirmed door swing be recorded?

- A confirmed fact
- An open assumption with an owner
- Ignore it to finish faster

Correct: An open assumption with an owner. The swing may change the cabinet's position or depth, so it needs confirmation before design approval.

Which acceptance criterion is testable?

- The cabinet looks beautiful
- The cabinet is large
- The confirmed bag can be inserted and removed without a clash

Correct: The confirmed bag can be inserted and removed without a clash. It names a known item and a movement that can be tested.

Practice

Write an entrance-storage brief for a real user. Keep unconfirmed dimensions open until the site is surveyed.

User, contents and priorities

Constraints, assumptions and confirmation owners

Two acceptance criteria and their evidence

Review your work against the criteria. Saving it does not constitute technical project approval.

- Requirements connect to an activity.
- Assumptions are visible and unconfirmed.
- Each acceptance criterion has a verification method.